

mance in 15 minutes, which is pretty good. I also noticed that the heating is very much in check even when you're gaming for longer periods; with the maximum surface temperature reaching 35.4 degrees Celsius after 30 minutes of gameplay.

In daily usage, the phone feels smooth and jitter-free. Animations look solid and the phone can keep up with pretty much any everyday task you throw at it. You can game at 90 FPS on popular titles like BGMI and Call of Duty: Mobile at stable frame rates. GT Mode is a great gaming tool that lets you get smooth gameplay with support for features like Geek Power Tuning (which allows you to manage clock speeds), Game Focus Mode, Voice Changer, and more.

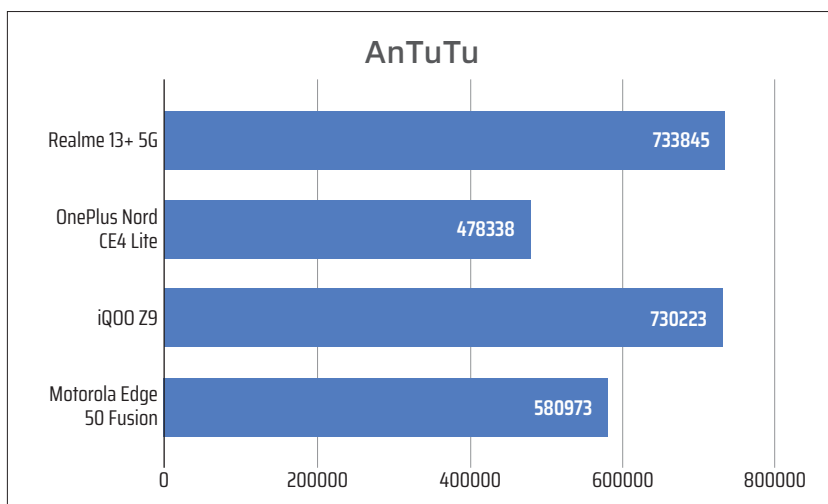
The phone, however, is riddled with bloatware in the form of third-party apps. The infamous Hot Apps and Hot Games are here, and so are other third-party apps like Reelshort, Spotify, Fin-shell Pay, Myntra, and a bunch of games. There are also a fair number of ad notifications you get from time to time, which soures the overall experience. The phone should get 2 Android updates and 3 years of security updates.

Realme UI 5.0 based on Android 14 has some notable features like File Dock, Flash Capsule, Smart Sidebar, and Smart Image Matting. The phone has AI Boost 2.0 which optimises app performance based on usage patterns. Other AI features include AI Smart Loop and AI Clear Voice, and I really like how AI Smart Loop is integrated.

CAMERA

The Realme 13+ 5G has a 50 MP Sony LYT-600 primary with an unspecified 2 MP secondary shooter. The practice of adding nominal 2 MP shooters in place of useful ultrawide cameras is something I hope brands phase out in the near future as the functionality of these cameras is limited. I would have preferred an 8 MP ultrawide here in place of the 2 MP camera.

Now, the primary 50 MP Sony camera clicks solid photos in daylight



with good dynamic range and close to accurate colours. However, I did notice some HDR blooming in a couple of shots. Close-up photos have good natural bokeh and portrait photos have great skin tones but average edge detection. 2x in sensor zoom photos are decent detail and dynamic range too.

Low-light photography is decent, with good colours and dynamic range but limited detail retention. As for selfies, the results were disappointing as the camera failed to capture textures and struggled against harsh lighting.

BATTERY LIFE

Equipped with a 5,000 mAh battery, the Realme 13+ 5G surprised me with its battery's endurance. The phone easily gave me 6-7 hours of on-screen time on a daily basis with medium to heavy usage. Even playing intensive games like Call of Duty Mobile for half an hour only dropped the battery percentage by 6 per cent, which is impressive.

The phone supports 80 W fast charging to top up the battery. The charger inside the box juices up the phone from 0-100% in just 47 minutes, which is pretty speedy.

VERDICT

The Realme 13+ 5G is a gaming beast on a budget. With the Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 processor, a sophisticated cooling system, and 90 FPS gaming support, the phone is an obvious choice for

mobile gaming enthusiasts. And it's not a one-trick pony. The 6.67-inch OLED display is bright and crisp, the battery life is impressive, with excellent endurance and fast charging capabilities, and the primary camera produces solid results. The phone's design, however, feels lacklustre compared to other Realme models, and the lack of an ultrawide camera is disappointing. Additionally, the phone's bloatware is just excessive; there's no mild way to put it. Despite these misses, the Realme 13+ 5G has the makings of a great budget phone, one not just catered to power users and gamers but also those who look for a more holistic experience. However, I do believe, the phone would be infinitely more appealing had it been priced under ₹20,000. At ₹22,999, it gets slightly overshadowed by the iQOO Z9, although I do believe the Realme 13+ is slightly superior thanks to its balanced camera performance.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Dimensity 7300 Energy | GPU: Arm Mali-G615 | RAM: 8GB/12GB LPDDR4X | ROM: 128GB/256GB UFS 3.1 | Display: 6.67" 120Hz OLED | Refresh Rate: Up to 120Hz | Camera: 50MP Sony LYT-600 OIS Camera + 2 MP Unspecified Camera | Selfie Camera: 16 MP | Charging & Battery: 80W Ultra Charge, 5000mAh (typ) Battery

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